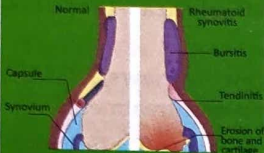


CHAPTER

45



Amavata

Learning Objectives

- ⇒ To learn the concept of Amavata
- ⇒ To simplify the Nidana and Samprapti of Amavata
- ⇒ To understand the Lakshana of Amavata
- ⇒ To learn the types of Amavata
- ⇒ To learn the Sadhyasadyata of Amavata

Introduction

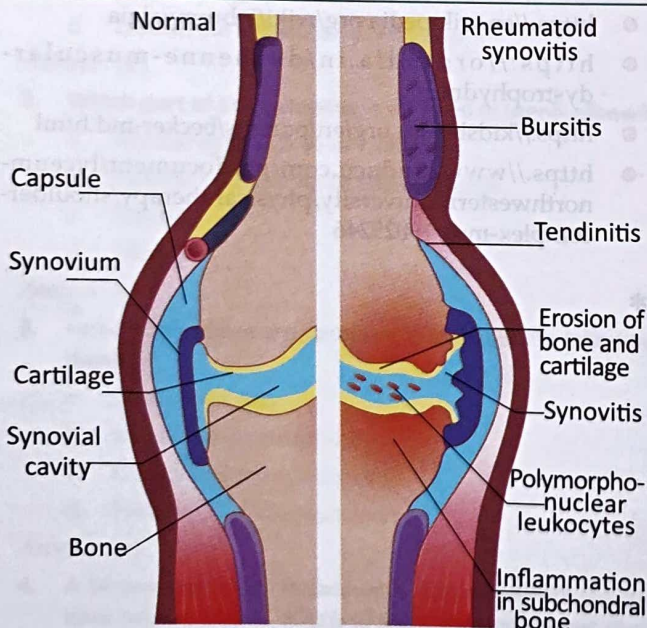


Figure 206: Normal joint and joint of rheumatoid arthritis

Amavata consists of two terms –

1. Ama and
 2. Vata.
- ⊕ These are two distinct entities where specific

aetiological factors are leading to the vitiation of Ama as well as Vata.

- ⊕ Ama is vitiated by Santarpanaja Nidana (body tissue nourishing factors) and Vata is vitiated by Apatarpanaja Nidana (body tissue depleting factors).
- ⊕ Amavata is mainly a disease of Rasavaha Srotas.
- ⊕ Depending upon the chronology of development of symptoms, we can observe the involvement of Annavaha, Rasavaha, Asthivaha and Majjavaha Srotas.
- ⊕ We can notice the involvement of Abhyantara, Bahya and Madhyama Rogamarga sequentially based on the progression of the disease.
- ⊕ The disease is characterised by swelling of the joints associated with multiple joint pain preceded and associated with impaired appetite.
- ⊕ As the disease involves the Madhyama Rogamarga, we can substantiate the incurability of the illness, as it is difficult to bring the vitiated Doshas from Madhyama Rogamarga to Koshttha when compared to the displacement of vitiated Dosha from Shakha to Koshttha.

Nidana of Amavata

विरुद्धाहारचेष्टस्य मन्दानेर्निश्चलस्य च।
स्निग्धं भुक्तवतो हा व्यायामं कुर्वतस्तथा॥

- ⊕ The causative factors of Amavata are:

Ma.Ni. – 25/1

- *Viruddha¹ hara²* (Indulgence in unwholesome diet)
- *Viruddha Cheshta³* (indulgence in unwholesome habits)
- *Nischala⁴* (lack of physical activity)
- *Mandagni⁵* (reduced digestive fire)
- *Snigdham Bhuktavato Vyayamam Kurvatah⁶* (performing the physical activity on consumption of unctuous substances)
- ⊙ These aetiological factors will vitiate the *Vata Dosha* and promote the accumulation of *Ama* in *Amashaya*.

Samprapti of Amavata

बायुना प्रेरितो ह्यामः श्लेष्मस्थानं प्रधावति।
तेनात्यर्थं विदग्धोऽसौ धमनीः प्रतिपद्यते॥2॥
वातपित्तकर्फभूयो दूषितः सोऽन्नजो रसः।
स्रोतांस्यभिष्यन्दयति नानावर्णोऽतिपिच्छिलः॥3॥
जनयत्याशु दौर्बल्यं गौरवं हृदयस्य च।
व्याधीनामाश्रयो होष आमसंशोऽतिदारुणः॥4॥
युगपत्कुपितावन्तस्त्रिकसन्धिप्रवेशको।
स्रब्धं च कुरुतो गात्रमामवातः स उच्यते॥5॥

Ma.Ni. - 25/2-5

- ⊙ The vitiated *Vata* and already accumulated *Ama* in the

Amashaya will move into the sites of *Kapha Dosha* (i.e. *Amashaya*, *Uras*, *Shiras*, *Kantha* and *Sandhi*) leading to the filling of these sites and *Dhamani* with waxy material.

- ⊙ Thus, there will be the vitiation of *Vata*, *Pitta* and *Kapha* which further vitiates *Ahara Rasa* which will have different colours.
- ⊙ This *Ahara Rasa* will move into *Rasavaha Srotas* resulting in the blockage of channels.
- ⊙ The whole pathophysiology leads to the clinical features such as weakness of the individual, heaviness of the precordium.
- ⊙ The main culprit in the manifestation of the disease is termed as *Ama* and is the root cause of many distressing diseases.
- ⊙ Simultaneously vitiated *Dosha* i.e. *Vata* and *Kapha* will enter the *Trika Sandhi* and all joints leading to stiffness of the body leading to the manifestation of *Amavata*⁷.

- 1 Charaka Samhita in his 26th chapter of Sutra Sthana, has mentioned different examples of *Viruddha Ahara* such as consumption of meat of domestic animals such as chicken with honey or jaggery or milk or blackgram or sprouted cereals etc or consumption of ghee and honey in equal quantity etc. Refer verses 84 to 106 of 26th chapter of Sutra Sthana of Charaka Samhita for the detailed description of *Viruddha* concept.

Madhu; Ma.Ni.- 25/1

- 2 **विरुद्धाहारः संयोगादिविरुद्धः,**

Madhu; Ma.Ni. - 25/1

- 3 **विरुद्धा च चेष्टा यथा- वायजलप्रतरणादि।**

The term *Viruddha Ahara* refers to consumption of milk and fish together frequently and this is an example of *Samyoga Viruddha*. The term *Viruddha Cheshta* refers to indulgence in exercise, sexual intercourse and swimming etc activities in a state of indigestion. These activities initially lead to the shift of the blood from the alimentary canal to the skeletal muscles. This mechanism will worsen the process of digestion, thereby macromolecular substances cannot be converted into absorbable micromolecular substances, thus, there will partially digested substances may remain in the alimentary canal, which will move into the blood stream via lymphatic system into circulatory system.

- 4 When an individual is having lack of physical activity, that will lead to poor circulation in the body. As there is inflammation present in the joints, that will lead to the more amount of transfer of the fluid from the small vessels into the interstitial compartment, that will lead to slower movement of the blood in the small vessels in the areas of the joints. This phenomenon is called sludging of blood. Because of slower movement of the blood in the small vessels, the person will have heaviness of the body parts. This is being termed as *Gourava* of the body.
- 5 *Mandagni* is responsible for the poor conversion of macromolecular substances into the micromolecular substances. Because of the presence of *Ama* (poor digested macromolecular to intermediate substances) will enter the lymphatic system. The further pathological events are similar to the events described in *Nischala* context.
- 6 In this, there are two aspects one has to consider:

1. Person consumes *Snigdha* (unctuous) substances
2. Performing *Vyayama* (exercise) after consumption of food normal amount of food, there will be shift in the circulation of blood from the alimentary canal to the musculo skeletal system, bones, joints, skeletal muscles in particular. If the person consumes unctuous substances, there will be much delay in the digestion of food substances as these substances are having heavier molecular weight. Because of the heavier weight, the food substances remain in the *Amashaya* (stomach) for longer time (more than 2 hours). This will lead to the mucosal damage of the stomach because of bacterial proliferation and inflammation. Because of the inflammation, the person starts to reduce the physical activity. When there is reduced physical activity, Due to reduced physical activity, the blood circulation usually slows down around the musculo skeletal system, thus there is more chance of inflammatory reaction in the musculo skeletal system.

- 7 As far as the *Nidana* of *Amavata* is concerned, the *Nidana* mentioned in this context are the perfect example of the *Ubhaya Hetu* where there will be exposure to aetiological factors which leads to involvement of manifestation of *Ama* and vitiation of *Vata* are simultaneously observed in an individual. Vitiation of *Ama* leads to the increase of *Kapha Dosha* and exposure to etiological factors leading to the vitiation of *Vata Dosha* we are going to observe increase of *Vata Dosha*.

- *Jvara*¹² (fever)
- *Apaka*¹³ (impaired digestion)
- *Anganam Shunata*¹⁴ (swelling of the body parts)

Pravridha Amavata Lakshana

सकष्टः सर्वरोगाणां यदा प्रकुपितो भवेत्।
हस्तपादशिरोगुल्फत्रिकजानूरुसन्धिषु॥7॥
करोति सरुजं शोथं यत्र दोषः प्रपद्यते स
देशो रुज्यतेऽत्यर्थं व्याविद्ध इव पृश्निकैः॥8॥
जनयेत्सोऽग्निदौर्बल्यं प्रसेकारुचिगौरवम्।
उत्साहहानिं वैरस्यं दाई च बहुमूत्रताम्॥9॥
कुक्षौ कठिनतां शुलं तथा निद्राविपर्ययम्।
बृद्धिर्दिभ्रममूर्च्छाश्च हृद्ग्रहं विविबद्धताम्।
जाड्यान्त्रकूजमानाहं कष्टांश्चान्यानुपद्रवान्॥11॥ Ma.Ni. – 25/7-10

- The disease is associated with painful swellings of joints of *Hasta* (hand), *Pada* (feet), *Shira* (head), *Gulpha* (ankle region), *Trika* (sacral region), *Janu* (knee joint), *Uru* (thigh)
- The nature of pain is similar to scorpion bite i.e. pertaining to the joint only.
- The disease is also associated with *Agnidaurbalya* (weak digestive fire), *Praseka* (excessive salivation), *Aruchi* (tastelessness), *Gaurava* (heaviness of the body parts), *Utsahahani* (lack of enthusiasm), *Vairasya* (abnormal taste perception), *Daha* (burning sensation), *Bahumutrata* (excess frequency of micturition), *Kukshi Kathinata* (hardness of the abdomen), *Shula* (pain abdomen), *Nidra Viparyaya* (sleep disturbances), *Trishna* (thirst), *Chardi* (vomiting), *Bhrama* (giddiness), *Murcha* (altered state of consciousness), *Vid Vibaddhata* (constipation), *Jadya* (sluggishness), *Antrakujana* (gurgling sounds in the abdomen), *Anaha* (distension of the abdomen).

Key summary of the chapter

- *Amavata* consists of two terms: *Ama* and *Vata*. Here, *Ama* is formed in the body because of excess consumption of substances which increase *Kapha* and *Vata* will be vitiated in the body because of the excess exposure of the body to *Vata* vitiating factors. The causative factors for the manifestation of *Amavata* are considered to be *Dosha* and *Vyadhi* - *Ubhaya Hetu* as these two are separately responsible for the increase of *Ama* and *Vata* in the body.
- The causative factors of *Amavata* are consumption of *Viruddha Ahara* (unwholesome diet), *Viruddha Cheshta* (unwholesome habits), *Nishchala* (lack of physical activity), *Mandagni* (reduced digestive fire) and performing

Bheda of Amavata

Sankhya Samprapti of *Amavata* is 7 types depending upon the dominance of *Dosha* in the individuals.

पिचात्सदाहरागं च सशूलं पवनानुगम्।
स्तिमितं गुरुकडूं च कफदुष्टं तमादिशेत्॥1॥ Ma.Ni. – 25/11

Vata dominant *Amavata* is associated with *Shula* (pain); *Pitta* dominant *Amavata* is associated with *Daha* (burning sensation) and *Raga* (redness) and *Kapha* dominant *Amavata* is associated with *Stimita* (feeling of covering of body with wet clothes), *Guru* (heaviness of the body) and *Kandu* (itching).

7 types of Amavata

1. *Vataja Amavata*
2. *Pittaja Amavata*
3. *Kaphaja Amavata*
4. *Vatapittaja Amavata*
5. *Pittakaphaja Amavata*
6. *Vatakaphaja Amavata*
7. *Sannipataja Amavata*

Sadhyasadyata¹⁵ of Amavata

एकदोषानुगः साध्यो द्विदोषो याप्य उच्यते।

सर्वदेहचरः शोथः सः कृच्छ्रः सान्निपातिकः॥2॥ Ma.Ni. – 25/12

- *Amavata* manifested due to single *Dosha* vitiation is considered as *Sadhyasadyata* (easily curable disease)
- *Amavata* manifested due to dual *Dosha* vitiation is considered as *Ya-pya* (manageable disease)
- *Amavata* manifested due to *Tridosha* vitiation and there is swelling of whole body, then such disease is difficult to cure

- 12 Inflammatory events happening in the joint spaces in most of the body parts, the person may have local raise of body temperature. In this situation, the person will lack of appetite secondary to reduction in the blood supply in the alimentary canal and simultaneous increase of blood supply to the inflamed joints of the body.
 - 13 This is attributable to similar mechanism happening in widespread joints of the body. This inflammatory event will lead to the
 - 14 This is attributable to increased inflammatory reactions happening in widespread joints of the body. Thus, the person with
 - 15 This is attributable to increased inflammatory fluid containing inflammatory markers to accumulate in the inflamed joints. Thus, the person with more amount of influx of inflammatory fluid containing inflammatory markers to accumulate in the inflamed joints. Thus, the person with inflammatory joint involvement, will have mild to moderate to severe joint swelling.
- Sadhyasadyata of any disease is predicted by various factors such as duration of the illness, involvement of number of joints, involvement of number of vitiated *Dosha*, involvement of *Srotas*, *Agni* etc plays a major role. For example, in *Madhava Nidana*, the main criteria in predicting *Sadhyasadyata* of *Amavata*, number of *Dosha* are involved, curability of the illness is little bit debatable. In *Pitta* and *Kapha* dominant disease is easy. In case of multitude of vitiated *Dosha* are involved, curability of the illness is little bit debatable. In *Pitta* and *Kapha* dominant *Amavata*, line of treatment is totally different, *Santarpana* (nourishment) is ideal in *Pitta* dominant situation and *Apatarpana* (depletion of nourishment from the body) is ideal in *Kapha* dominant *Amavata*, that is why *Pitta* *Kapha* dominant *Amavata*, is difficult to cure.

Vyayama after consuming *Snigdha Ahara* (unctuous substances).

- ⊗ Consumption of these aetiological factors will lead to the vitiation of *Ama* and *Vata*, thereby responsible for affliction of *Rasa*, derangement of *Rasavaha Srotas* is observed with *Sanga* and *Vimargagamana* during the progression of the disease.
- ⊗ No *Purvarupa* (prodromal symptoms) are mentioned in the *Ayurveda* textbooks.
- ⊗ *Angamarda* (bodyache), *Aruchi* (tastelessness), *Trishna* (thirst), *Alasya* (laziness), *Gourava* (heaviness of the body parts), *Jvara* (raised body temperature), *Apaka* (indigestion), *Anganam Shunata* (swelling of the body parts) are the *Samanya Lakshana* of *Amavata* mentioned in *Madhava Nidana*.
- ⊗ As far as *Sankhya Samprapti* of *Amavata* is concerned, 7 types of *Amavata* are mentioned depending upon the *Dosha* dominance during the progression of the disease. They are *Vataja*, *Pittaja*, *Kaphaja*, *Vatapittaja*, *Pittakaphaja*, *Kaphavataja*, *Vatapittakaphaja*.
- ⊗ *Vyavidhha Iva Vrischikaih* – localised severe pain in the joints is the characteristic feature of advanced stage of *Amavata*.
- ⊗ *Amavata* which is manifested due to vitiation of single *Dosha* is easily curable; *Amavata* with dual *Dosha* involvement is difficult to cure and *Amavata* with involvement of all three *Dosha* is very difficult to cure.

Self-Assessment: Questions for Review

Long essays questions

- ⊗ Define *Amavata*. Explain *Nidana*, *Samprapti*, *Lakshana*, *Sadhyasadyata* of *Amavata*
- ⊗ Explain *Nidana Panchaka* of *Amavata*

Short essays questions

- ⊗ Explain *Nidana* and *Samprapti* of *Amavata*
- ⊗ Describe the *Lakshana* of *Amavata*
- ⊗ Explain *Pravridhha Amavata Lakshana*

Short answers

- ⊗ Define *Amavata*
- ⊗ Enumerate the *Sankhya Samprapti* of *Amavata*
- ⊗ Explain in brief about *Sadhyasadyata* of *Amavata*
- ⊗ Write the *Samanya Lakshana* of *Amavata*

MCQs

1. As per *Madhava Nidana*, the types of *Amavata* are

- a. 3; b. 4;
- c. 5; d. 7

Answer: (d)

2. *Sa rujyate Atyartham Vyavidhha Iva Vrischikai* is the specific feature of

- a. *Amavata*; b. *Ushnavata*;
- c. *Vatashonita*; d. *Kshinavata*

Answer: (a)

3. Separate chapter on *Amavata* is mentioned in

- a. *Charaka Samhita*; b. *Sushruta Samhita*;
- c. *Ashtanga Hridaya*; d. *Madhava Nidana*

Answer: (d)

4. Type of *Srotodushti* involved in the manifestation of *Amavata* is/are

- a. *Atipravritti*;
- b. *Sanga*;
- c. *Sanga* and *Vimargagamana*;
- d. *Siragranthi*

Answer: (c)

5. *Kapha* dominant *Amavata* is considered to be

- a. *Sadhya*;
- b. *Krichrasadhya*;
- c. *Asadhya*;
- d. All of the above

Answer: (a)

Chapter resources

- ⊗ <https://orthoinfo.aaos.org/en/diseases--conditions/rheumatoid-arthritis/>
- ⊗ *Madhava Nidana* – 25th chapter: *Amavata Nidana*
- ⊗ *Golwalla's medicine for students* by Aspi F Golwalla and Sharukh A Golwalla, edited by Milind Y Nadkar, 25th edition, Jaypee Brothers Medical Publishers (P) Ltd, New Delhi, 2017
- ⊗ *The Merck Manual of Diagnosis and Therapy* by Robert S Porter and Justin L Kaplan, 19th edition, Merck Sharp & Dohme Corp, New Jersey, 2011
- ⊗ *Chamberlain's symptoms and signs in clinical medicine* by Colin Ogilvie and Christopher C Evans, 12th edition, Butterworth-Heinemann Publishers, 1997
- ⊗ *Best & Taylor's physiological basis of medical practice* by O P Tandon and Y Tripathi, 13th edition, Wolters Kluwer Health (India) Pvt. Ltd, Gurgaon, 2012
- ⊗ *Textbook of Medical physiology* by Arthur C Guyton and John E Hall, 11th edition, Saunders Elsevier publications, Philadelphia, 2006
